

Clap

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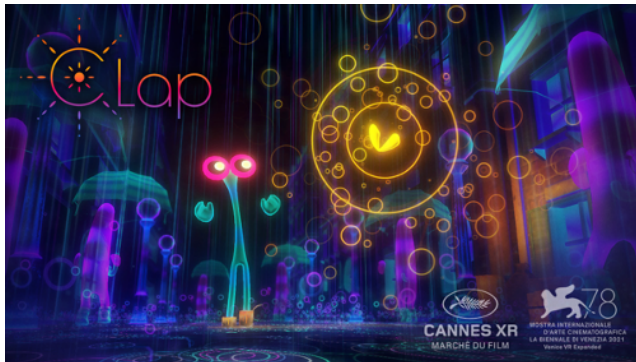
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1 EXPERIENCE DESCRIPTION

In this piece, the user's 'Clap' becomes an important interaction in the story. Once you clap, you enter into the consciousness of the protagonist, "Thread man".

It is a fantastical and slightly melancholy world.

The user is made to think about the meaning of the applause they give as they interact with the thread man by clapping their hands. They will surely want to give him a round of applause by the end of the story.

Sound is a key element in this piece. The music and sound effects were created with 11ch stereo sound and enhance the user's immersion in the story, resulting in a deeper connection with the piece's message. The sound quality of the applause changes as the story progresses. As the sound quality changes, the user is able to understand the various meanings of applause.

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2 MAIN CHARACTER

"Thread man", the protagonist, lacks self-confidence, and feels so intently that he has no redeeming features that he has shrunk to a thread-like existence.

Viewers can interact with the character by clapping their hands.

3 LOGLINE

"Thread man", the protagonist, lacks self-confidence, has shrunk to a thread-like existence. Why did he become scared of the sound of clapping? When your heartfelt applause reaches the thread man, that signals the beginning of a beautiful sound.

4 STORY

Clapping is a way of expressing emotions by using one's own body to create sound. When people want to express their admiration, they channel their emotions into their hands and clap, with energy and feeling, even if it means withstanding physical discomfort. But does that feeling ever reach the other person? In 'Clap,' the protagonist is the target of applause, and the story unfolds from the point of view of a person clapping. "Thread man", the protagonist, lacks self-confidence, and feels so intently that he has no redeeming features that he has shrunk to a thread-like existence.

One rainy day, the thread man is walking down an alley when an empty, rusty can falls in front of him. The can reverberates with a pleasant and amusing sound, and, taken in by it, he tries to recreate the sound himself by wearing the can on his foot and starting to dance.

Of the many people who pass by the thread man, a girl notices him and stops to watch. She channels her appreciation of the sound into applause, which makes him happy, and in pursuit of more of this feeling, he becomes even more lost in the dance.

Soon a crowd of people gather around the thread man, and the sound of applause grows ever louder, though with the increased volume comes increased pressure, which troubles the thread man.

Even so, he continues to dance before the audience. Eventually, feeling cornered, he tries to escape from the applause and falls into darkness.

It is when he is in this darkness that you first stand face-to-face with the thread man.

Why did the thread man become scared of the sound of clapping and why could he no longer enjoy it?

Why does he reject your applause, and why do your emotions not reach him?

When your heartfelt applause reaches the thread man, the original meaning of clapping is restored, which signals the beginning of a beautiful sound.

5 DIRECTOR'S STATEMENT

"Clap" is a work of VR animation that you can experience simply by clapping your hands. A number of meanings are imbued in that single action, however, making the interaction of "Clap" quite profound.

Life doesn't always go as we like, and we sometimes get depressed. At times like that, I invite you to encourage others, and yourself as well, through "Clap."

All right, then. Clap your hands a lot with a positive attitude!

6 DIRECTOR: KEISUKE ITOH

Keisuke Itoh is a VR animation director. He graduated from Tama Art University's Department of Graphic Design. After working as a graphic designer for a manufacturing company, he became a freelance CGI artist in 2012. In 2019, his VR animation "Feather" premiered at the 76th Venice International Film Festival in the

Biennale College Selection as the first Japanese film in the VR category. In 2020 and 2021, his "Beat" "Clap" was nominated in the competition section of the same festival. In addition, his works have been screened at numerous film festivals, including the Berlin International Film Festival, Busan International Film Festival, and SIGGRAPH.

7 SCREENING HISTORY

- Venice International Film Festival
- Geneva International Film Festival / Pulsation section (out of competition)
- Lumiere Japan Award
- Qld XR Festival
- JEF festival 2022
- Geneva International Film Festival Unlimited Program
- Gabes Cinema Fen festival
- ZLIN FILM FESTIVAL
- Summer Film School Festival
- Cannes XR x VeeR Future Award
- Cannes XR Offline Showcase at VeeR